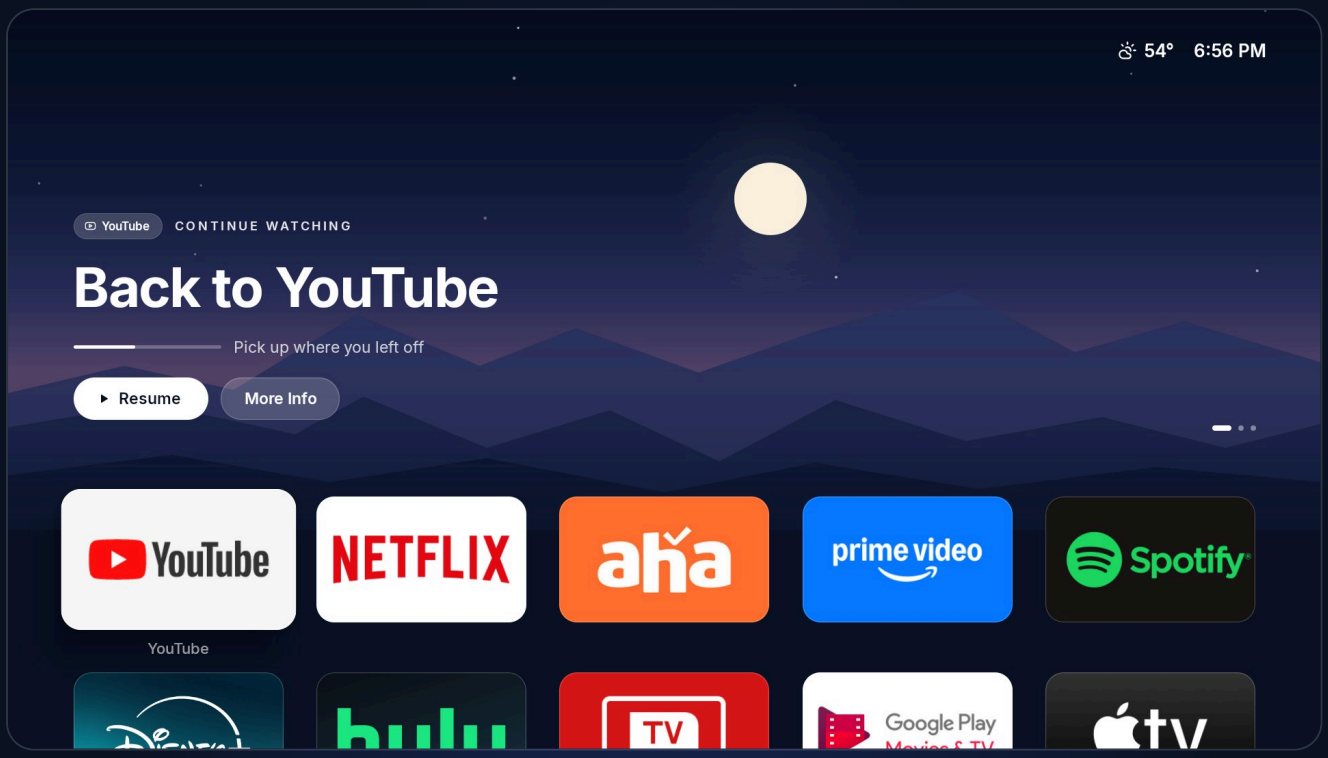
SETUP GUIDE · NO CODING NEEDED

Glass TV

Turn your Android TV or Google TV into an **ad-free, Apple TV-style home screen** with a **phone remote** that only works on your home Wi-Fi.

No ads on the home screen | Nothing uninstalled | Easy to undo | Home Wi-Fi only



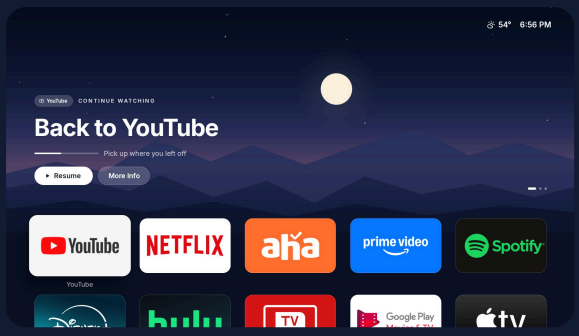
The finished home screen, running on a TCL Google TV

Made by
@thevikas.ai

Android TV · Google TV
TV only, or with a Mac or Windows computer

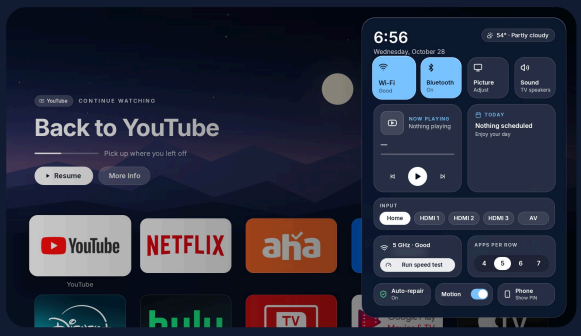
WHAT YOU GET

Four pieces, one calm TV



Glass Home

A big “Continue watching” picture on top, real app tiles below. The apps you use most move to the front.



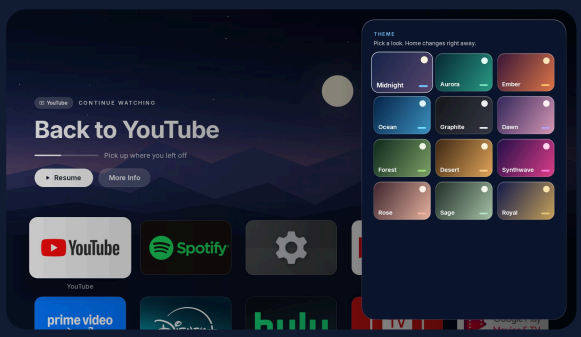
Control Center

Press the remote’s gear button over anything: Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, sound, now playing, inputs, speed test, themes.



Ambient mode

The screensaver: a big clock, weather, notes from your phone, your next event and photos.



12 themes

Midnight, Aurora, Ember, Ocean, Graphite, Dawn and more. One press changes the whole look.

Plus a phone remote, with no app to install

Open the TV’s address in your phone’s browser: arrows, typing, voice search, volume, and sending messages, photos and links to the TV.

BEFORE YOU START

What you need

The right kind of TV

It must run Android TV or Google TV (Android 9 or newer). To check: Settings → System → About. If you see “Android TV OS”, you’re good.

Works on: Sony, TCL (Google TV), Hisense (Google TV), Philips, Xiaomi, OnePlus, Chromecast with Google TV.
Not covered: Samsung (Tizen), LG (webOS), Roku TVs, Fire TV.

CHOOSE ONE	WHAT YOU NEED	WHAT YOU GET
Easy path Page 4	Just the TV	Glass home screen and phone remote
Full path Page 5	A Mac or Windows computer on the same Wi-Fi as the TV	All of that, and it switches off the TV’s ad and tracking apps. Best for TCL TVs.

Read this first

- Changing your TV’s software may void its warranty. Do this at your own risk.
- Glass never uninstalls anything from your TV, and you can undo it (page 8).
- This is a beta. It’s been tested on one TCL Google TV running Android 12, so other TVs may behave differently.
- Keep the TV powered on and on Wi-Fi during setup.

EASY PATH · TV ONLY

Install on the TV

Install Glass

1. On the TV, install **Downloader** from the Play Store.
2. Open Downloader and enter this link:

   ```
   tinyurl.com/glasstv-version
   ```

3. When Android asks, allow Downloader to install unknown apps, then press **Install**.

Follow Glass's setup screen

Open Glass. It walks you through **Turn on Glass**, **Show what's playing**, **Pick a look** and **Done: press Home**.

Two things that surprise people

Finding Glass: in Accessibility, Glass is at the very bottom of the Services list. Keep pressing Down.

The scary warning: Android shows "Glass can collect all of the text you type" for every accessibility app. Glass uses this only to catch the Home and settings buttons and to type what you send from your phone. It has no account and sends nothing to the internet except the weather you ask for.

If it says "Your TV blocked this"

This is common on Android 13 and newer. Use the Full path on the next page instead.

TCL TV?

TCL needs a small fix after every full restart with this path (page 9). Use the Full path if you have a computer.

FULL PATH · WITH A COMPUTER

Double-click setup

1 · Turn on USB debugging on the TV

1. Settings → System → About, then press OK on **Android TV OS build** 7 times.
2. Go back to Settings → System → Developer options and turn on **USB debugging**.
3. Write down the TV's IP address (Settings → Network & Internet → your Wi-Fi). It looks like `192.168.1.45`.

2 · Download the setup

From `github.com/saivikas373/glass-tv/releases/latest`, download **Glass-TV-Setup-Mac.zip** or **Glass-TV-Setup-Windows.zip**, then unzip it.

3 · Run it

1. Double-click **Glass-Setup**.
   Mac: the first time, right-click → Open → Open.
   Windows: if SmartScreen appears, More info → Run anyway.
2. Type your TV's IP address when it asks.
3. Press **Allow** on the TV.

What it does

It downloads Google's official ADB tool, backs up the TV, switches off a conservative list of ad and tracking apps (only if installed, never uninstalled), installs and turns on Glass, then closes debug access and deletes its key.

Keep the folder

Glass-Restore in that folder undoes everything.

EVERYDAY USE

Using your new TV

TV REMOTE	WHAT HAPPENS
Home	Always goes to Glass.
Home (hold)	Opens the old Google TV home: your escape hatch.
Gear	Opens Control Center over anything. Hold it for the TV's full Settings.
Up from the apps	Selects the big picture on top. Left and Right flip its pages.

Phone remote

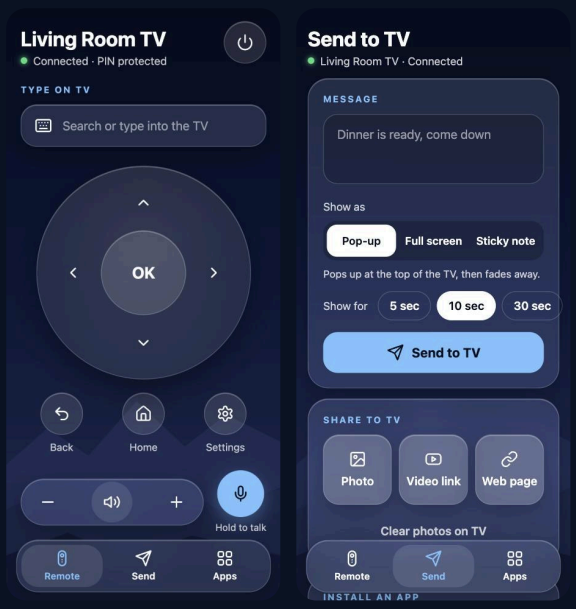
1. Join your home Wi-Fi on the phone.
2. On the TV, press the gear → **Phone · Show PIN**. It shows the address and a 6-digit PIN.
3. Open that address in your phone's browser and type the PIN.
4. Done. The phone stays paired. On iPhone, Share → **Add to Home Screen** makes it feel like an app.

What it does

Remote: arrows, OK, Back, Home, volume, power, and typing into the TV. For voice search, tap the mic on your phone's keyboard.

Send: a message as a pop-up, full screen or sticky note, plus photos and video or web links.

Apps: open any app, switch HDMI, speed test, theme, weather city and news feed.



SECURITY

Only your home Wi-Fi can control the TV

The phone page is built like a management interface on a home network: nothing is reachable from the internet, and nothing works without the PIN.

PROTECTION	HOW IT WORKS
Home Wi-Fi only	Listens only on the TV's Wi-Fi address and rejects anything from outside your home network.
PIN pairing	A new 6-digit PIN after every reboot. A paired phone gets a long secret token; the TV stores only a hash of it.
Lockout	5 wrong PINs lock pairing for 5 minutes and show a warning on the TV.
Web attacks	Blocks requests from other websites a phone happens to visit (wrong Host, foreign Origin, cross-site requests).
App installs	https links only, and you must confirm each install on the TV with the remote.
No outside access	No UPnP, no port forwarding, no cloud relay.
Debug access closed	The Full path switches debug access off when it finishes. The Easy path never turns it on.
Your control	Control Center lists paired phones, with a Forget all phones button.

Do these on your router

- UPnP off, or at least no automatic port forwards to the TV.
- No port forwards to the TV's IP.
- Guest Wi-Fi with client isolation for visitors, so they can't even see the TV.
- A DHCP reservation for the TV, so its IP (and your phone link) never changes.

KEEP IT WORKING

Repair, undo and known limits

After a TV update

If Glass shows **“TV updated: run repair”**:

- **Easy path:** go to Settings → Accessibility → Glass, turn it off, then on again.
- **Full path:** turn USB debugging on, then double-click **Glass-Setup** again.

Undo everything

- **Easy path:** uninstall Glass from Settings → Apps.
- **Full path:** turn USB debugging on, then double-click **Glass-Restore**. It switches back on what was switched off and returns the TV to how it was.

Known limits

- **Phone arrow keys don’t work inside YouTube** and some apps that draw their own screen. Android doesn’t let one app press keys in another. Use the phone page’s search and volume, or the TV remote.
- **Continue Watching** shows what’s playing now, or the app you use most. Android doesn’t let Glass read other apps’ watch history.
- **Today’s calendar** fills in once a Google calendar is synced to the TV.
- **Headlines** in ambient mode appear after you add a news feed (an https RSS link) from the phone.
- **Voice** uses your phone keyboard’s mic, because phone browsers block the microphone on plain http pages.

KEEP IT WORKING

TCL TVs and restarts

Use the computer setup if you can

TCL blocks apps from starting by themselves after a full restart, and only the computer setup can allow it.

If you used the TV-only setup

Glass still works, but after a restart you get the normal Google TV home until you fix it:

1. **Open Glass from your apps.** The phone remote comes back.
2. **Go to Settings → Accessibility → Glass, turn it off, then on again.** The Home button comes back.

When this happens

After a full restart, for example a power cut or a TV update. Other brands may do the same; this has only been tested on one TCL TV.

CREDITS

Built on great open-source work

CleanYourTV by Gathin

The tested debloat lists and the launcher base Glass starts from. MIT license.
`github.com/Gathin23/cleanyourtv`

TV Detox by Ansub Khan

Another great project that inspired this one. `github.com/Ansub/tv-detox`

Disclaimer

This guide is for personal, educational use. Changing your TV's software can void its warranty and carries some risk; you do it at your own risk. Glass TV is an independent hobby project, not affiliated with Apple, Google, TCL or any TV brand. App names and logos in the screenshots belong to their owners.

Built it? Tag me, I'd love to see your setup.

@thevikas.ai